How do animals in ecosystems compete for food?

All animals need to eat food. Plant-eaters may **forage** (search) for food among the plants, picking fruits, berries and nuts from trees and bushes. Others **graze** on crops planted by humans or grass. Most meat-eaters **hunt** and kill other animals.

Sometimes animals need to get their share of food by fighting each other. This is called **competition**. Sometimes it might be two members of the same species that are fighting – for example, two young monkeys might fight over a piece of fruit. Sometimes it is two different kinds of animals that fight for food – for example, a hyena might try to take some food from a lion.

☞ **1** Circle the word that relates to the way in which animals fight for food.

communication	competition	accommodation

2 Draw a line between each sentence starter and the most appropriate sentence ending.

a) Foraging means — chasing and killing another animal.

b) Grazing means — feeding on grass or plants.

c) Hunting means — searching for wild food.

3 Give two examples for each of the following.

a) animals that forage _____ _____

b) animals that graze _____ _____

c) animals that hunt _____ _____

4 What might help an animal win a contest for food? Underline all your choices.

speed	strength	sleepiness	having babies to feed
sharp claws	dancing ability	illness	being overweight
having an injury	poor eyesight	climbing ability	sharp teeth
intelligence	long fur	being healthy	camouflage

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